



Up and Down

The Wardens' columns

RITUAL

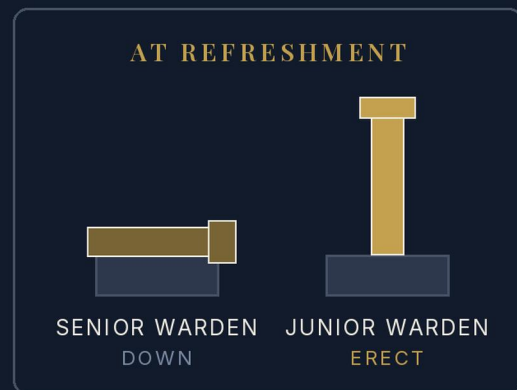
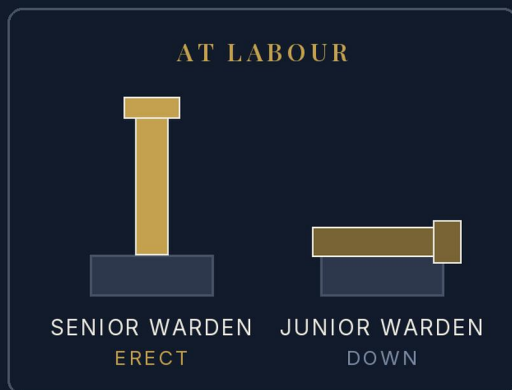
A small mechanical detail almost nobody watches, which turns out to carry the entire logic of opening, calling off, calling on and closing.

ON THE TABLE

The Senior and Junior Wardens' columns

THE WARDENS' COLUMNS

The only visible indication of what state the lodge is in. One glance at either pedestal tells a brother who has charge of him.



When the lodge is closed, both are down.

Calling off is not closing — the lodge is suspended, and passes from the Senior Warden's charge to the Junior Warden's in a single movement that takes about a second.

Diagram drawn for *The Vulcan Papers*.

HOW THE PAPER RUNS

0:00	Opening
1:00	What they are
2:30	Why those two
4:30	Calling off
6:00	The orders
7:30	Why this survives
9:00	Closing

THREE THINGS TO TAKE AWAY

- 1 Senior Warden's column erect at labour; Junior Warden's at refreshment; both down when closed.
- 2 Called off is not closed. The lodge is suspended, not ended, and can be called on without a fresh opening.
- 3 The columns are a signal designed for the brother who missed the words — a visitor, or a man back from the door.

IF YOU ARE ASKED

Which column is up during labour?

The Senior Warden's. The Junior Warden's is down.

And at refreshment?

They reverse. Both are down when the lodge is closed.

UP AND DOWN



Is calling off the same as closing?

No. Called off means suspended — the lodge still exists and can be called on again without a fresh opening.

Do all constitutions do it this way?

No. Practice varies, and the columns are a frequent point of difference when visiting. Watch rather than assume.

SOURCES

- Emulation Ritual — opening, closing, calling off and calling on
- Harry Carr, *The Freemason at Work* — on the Wardens' columns and variations between workings
- Colin Dyer, *Symbolism in Craft Freemasonry* — on the orders of architecture

Every paper is drawn from openly published masonic literature. Nothing here discloses the esoteric work of any degree; all of it is safe to deliver with visitors present, provided the visitors are brethren.

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